

Your Next 10 Workflows

Once you have one flow running, here's what to build next — ranked by hours-saved per dollar-spent, mapped by department and industry. Pick from this list. Don't reinvent.

From HitLai Institute — Module S5: “Scaling Up — From One Flow to Running Your Business”

HOW TO USE THIS LIST

After your first flow has been running for 30 days and you have measured ROI, pick your next 2-3 from this catalog. Don't try to guess what should be automated — let the catalog guess for you, then validate against YOUR business.

Each entry below has: - **What it does** - **Hours saved/month** (typical SMB range) - **Risk level** — what happens if AI gets it wrong - **Starting trust setting** - **Systems it touches**

TIER 1 — DO THESE FIRST (UNIVERSALLY HIGH-ROI)

1. Inbound inquiry triage

What it does: Watches your customer-facing inbox. Tags each new message by intent (sales / support / billing / partnership). Routes to the right person or queue. Drafts the first reply for routine ones. **Hours saved/month:** 12-25 **Risk level:** Low — wrong routing is recoverable in minutes. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. **Systems:** Email/WhatsApp/web chat, CRM, Slack or routing tool.

2. Weekly executive report

What it does: Pulls last week's numbers from CRM, accounting, and ops. Writes a 1-page summary in your format. Lands in your inbox before your Monday coffee. **Hours saved/month:** 8-16 **Risk level:** Very low — you read before sending. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. Graduate to “handles routine” within 60 days. **Systems:** CRM, accounting, ops tools, email.

3. Invoice intake → accounting

What it does: Vendor emails an invoice. AI extracts vendor, total, due date, line items. Drafts entry in your accounting system. Below your dollar threshold, scheduled for payment. Above, routed to you. **Hours saved/month:** 15-30 **Risk level:** Low to Medium — duplicate-invoice risk is the main thing to watch. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. Graduate slowly to “handles routine” only for known vendors below your threshold. **Systems:** Email, accounting (QuickBooks / Xero / NetSuite), file storage.

4. Customer FAQ response

What it does: Matches incoming customer questions to your approved response library. Drafts the reply. Routes to your team for approval. **Hours saved/month:** 20-50 (heavy support businesses) **Risk level:**

Low — you read every reply before send. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. Graduate FAQ-only after 20 right-every-time. **Systems:** Inbox, CRM, response library, channel widgets.

5. Proposal generation

What it does: RFP arrives. AI drafts proposal pulling from your CRM data + approved pricing + template. Routes to you for approval. Sends. Logs. Schedules follow-up. **Hours saved/month:** 8-20 **Risk level:** Low to Medium — wrong pricing is the main risk; locked pricing solves it. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. **Systems:** Email, CRM, doc tool, calendar.

TIER 2 — DO THESE AFTER YOU HAVE 3 TIER-1 FLOWS RUNNING

6. Contract intake → calendar + CRM

What it does: Signed contract uploaded. AI extracts parties, term, renewal date, auto-renewal Y/N, key dates. Calendar entries created. Filed. CRM updated. **Hours saved/month:** 6-15 **Risk level:** Medium — auto-renewal misses are expensive. **Starting setting:** AI suggests, you write. Graduate cautiously, only for standard agreements. **Systems:** DMS / file storage, CRM, calendar.

7. Customer onboarding doc collection

What it does: New customer signs. AI sends doc-request email. Tracks what arrives, validates required fields, sends polite reminders for missing items. **Hours saved/month:** 8-14 **Risk level:** Low. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. Graduate to “handles routine” after 10 successful onboardings. **Systems:** Email, CRM, file storage.

8. Lead research before every meeting

What it does: Calendar event scheduled with an external person. 30 minutes before the meeting, AI sends you a 1-page brief: their company, their role, recent news, likely priorities, talking points. **Hours saved/month:** 6-12 **Risk level:** Very low — internal-only, you read before the meeting. **Starting setting:** AI handles routine — Day 1. **Systems:** Calendar, CRM, web research, email.

9. Expense receipt → bookkeeping

What it does: Snap receipt with phone. AI extracts vendor, amount, date, category. Matches against card transactions. Drafts expense entry. **Hours saved/month:** 5-12 **Risk level:** Low. **Starting setting:** AI acts, you approve. Graduate “handles routine” under your dollar threshold. **Systems:** Phone/email, accounting / bookkeeping app.

10. Slack / Teams “ask the company” agent

What it does: Internal team asks a question in Slack (“What’s our return policy?”, “Where’s the latest pricing doc?”). AI answers from your approved knowledge base. Flags anything it can’t answer to the right person. **Hours saved/month:** 8-20 (the hidden tax on your senior team) **Risk level:** Low — internal-

facing, not public. **Starting setting:** AI handles routine for documented knowledge. AI suggests for anything else. **Systems:** Slack/Teams, knowledge base / docs, CRM.

INDUSTRY-SPECIFIC ADD-ONS

Professional services (consulting, agencies, professional firms)

- **Time tracking → invoice generation** (15-25 hrs/month)
- **Project status updates from team Slack/email** (8-12 hrs/month)
- **Client report generation from project data** (10-20 hrs/month)

E-commerce / retail

- **Order status auto-response** (handled by Tier 1 #4)
- **Inventory reorder alerts → vendor PO** (10-20 hrs/month)
- **Customer review response drafting** (5-10 hrs/month)
- **Returns intake and triage** (8-15 hrs/month)

Distribution / wholesale

- **Customer order intake from email/WhatsApp → ERP** (15-30 hrs/month)
- **Pricing-list update notifications** (4-8 hrs/month)
- **Customer credit-limit checks before order release** (6-12 hrs/month)

Field service / home service

- **Job dispatch from inbound inquiry** (10-20 hrs/month)
- **Photo + invoice intake from technicians in the field** (8-15 hrs/month)
- **Customer satisfaction follow-up** (handled by Tier 1 #4)

Healthcare adjacent / wellness / fitness (non-clinical)

- **Appointment scheduling from text/email** (15-25 hrs/month)
- **Intake form auto-completion from prior records** (8-12 hrs/month)
- **Insurance verification status tracking** (10-18 hrs/month)
- ⚠ Anything PHI-touching: route to a self-hosted HitLai deployment, not the SMB default.

Legal / accounting / regulated

- All flows above PLUS specific privilege-protection and supervision considerations.
 - ⚠ Take a vertical-track Institute module instead of relying only on the SMB curriculum.
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THE GRAND PRIZE

Year 1 reasonable target for an SMB running this list:

- **3 departments deeply covered** (sales, finance, customer)

- **12-18 flows total**, mixed across “you approve” and “handles routine”
- **30-50% of routine work** handled by AI on its own, the rest with your team’s approval
- **The team you have today** doing 2-3x the output, focused on high-judgment work

Not “AI replaces your team.” AI + your team + your systems running together.

WHAT NOT TO DO

- ✗ **Do not pick all 10 at once.** Maximum 2-3 per quarter. Anything more guarantees half-built flows.
- ✗ **Do not skip the trust journey.** A new flow always starts at “AI acts, you approve,” even if it’s a near-twin of one you’ve already graduated.
- ✗ **Do not have shared owners.** “Marketing and Sales both own this” = nobody owns it. One name per flow.
- ✗ **Do not assume the catalog is your priority list.** It’s a starting menu. YOUR priority is whichever flow your hours-saved data says is biggest.
- ✗ **Do not auto-graduate based on confidence.** Always require 20 right-in-a-row, recoverable risk, and explicit owner approval.

THE HITLAI ANSWER, IN ONE LINE

AI tools, your team, your systems — running together, safely.

This entire catalog is built into HitLai as templates — pick a flow, configure to your business, run it. AI starts where you’re comfortable. Your team owns the exceptions. Each part of your business moves at its own pace. Works with what you’ve got — Microsoft 365, your CRM, your accounting, your industry tools, the AI you already use. What we don’t have a connector for, the platform builds automatically in minutes, reviewed before it goes live. Every step auditable.

Want to map your specific 10 next flows live with the HitLai Institute team? That’s Module S5 — bring your business, leave with the plan. → hitlai.net/institute

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